

CAIO C. VELASCO

[Portfolio](#) | [LinkedIn](#)

+55 21 97601-6889 | caiocvelasco@gmail.com | Brazilian and EU citizen

Data Scientist focused on **Experimentation, Causal Inference, and Machine Learning**, with **6+ years of experience** across applied data science, data engineering, and quantitative research. Hands-on experience with **production data systems**, predictive modeling, and applied econometric research.

Mechanical Engineer with a Master's in Economics & Public Policy from UCLA. Awarded full scholarships from the Lemann and General Electric Foundations for academic excellence in Brazil and the USA. **Strong communicator and self-starter**, with **extensive stakeholder management and cross-functional experience** developed across multiple industries and nearly 10 years living in the USA, Netherlands, and Spain.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

DATA SCIENCE & QUANTITATIVE RESEARCH

FENG - Sports / Football

Rio de Janeiro, Brazil

Data Scientist, Churn & Reactivation (Remote, B2B)

November 2025 – March 2026

- Built a reactivation propensity model for inactive members of a football club loyalty program, ranking members by predicted return likelihood using engagement data, achieving ~0.94 AUC on a later holdout period and translating model scores into CRM targeting metrics for retention campaigns.

Royal Holloway University of London

London, UK

Research Assistant - Applied Econometrics (Remote, B2B)

November 2019 – April 2020

- Conducted applied econometric analysis in Python for a World Bank project examining climate change and agricultural productivity across African countries, working with Professor Juan Pablo Rud.

University of California Los Angeles

Los Angeles, USA

Research Assistant - Applied Econometrics (Remote, B2B)

September 2018 – June 2019

- Conducted econometric analysis in Python on the relationship between family planning and welfare access in the United States, working with Professor Adriana Lleras-Muney.

SELECTED INDUSTRY DATA EXPERIENCE

Independent Consulting

UK, USA, Brazil

Data & Analytics Engineering (Remote, B2B)

January 2022 – June 2026

Zurich Insurance & NTT Data Europe & Latam - Insurance

- Migrated ~100 legacy SAS data pipelines into production dbt-Databricks workflows, implementing modular transformations, incremental processing, automated data-quality checks, and CI/CD through Azure DevOps.

Javvy Coffee & Urban Stems - E-commerce

- Led a BI governance initiative that reduced ~800 Looker dashboards to ~80 actively used assets by using Python to cross-validate warehouse usage and dependency data.

Quext via Blue Orange Digital (USA, PropTech & Smart Home IoT)

- Led product and analytics engineering work for customizable reporting products across IoT, chatbot, financial, and property-management data, coordinating Data Engineers, Product Designers, and client stakeholders around a unified analytical data model.

FENG - Sports / Football

- Implemented a new Snowflake-dbt-DuckDB data architecture for payment data, migrating legacy Pentaho ETLs into modular ingestion and transformation pipelines using incremental strategies reducing processing time by 97% and lowering Snowflake infrastructure costs.

PREVIOUS BUSINESS-ORIENTED ROLES (2013 – 2017)

Stone Co, Credit Card Processor - Entrepreneur in Residence

- Stone is a Brazilian FinTech unicorn startup. I was its first employee, reporting directly to the founders. I designed the first draft of Stone's credit card reconciliation process.

MePrepara.com.br, a Mathematics Preparatory Online Course for GMAT and GRE - Founder

- Designed a fully automated math course with 150 videos to prepare low-income Brazilians for the mathematics part of GRE and GMAT exams, required at prestigious MBA and PhD programs worldwide.

EDUCATION

TILBURG UNIVERSITY

Tilburg, Netherlands

PhD in Economics (unfinished)

August 2020 – December 2021

- Top 5 European Economics Department. (*Due to family issues during COVID, I stopped and returned to Brazil*)
- Main topics: Advanced Mathematics and Statistics, Microeconomics, Causal Inference.

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA LOS ANGELES - UCLA

Los Angeles, USA

Master of Economics and Public Policy (Data Science track)

August 2017 – June 2019

- Top 15 university worldwide - *The Times Higher Education World University Rankings*.
- Main topics: Data Science, Multiple Regression Analysis, Causal Inference, Consumer Behavior.

FEDERAL UNIVERSITY OF RIO DE JANEIRO - UFRJ

Rio de Janeiro, Brazil

Bachelor of Science in Mechanical Engineering (5-year degree)

December 2012

- Top 8 Latin American university - *QS Latin America University Rankings 2023*.
- Graduated *cum laude*: Highest grade in the class of 2012 of 100+ students

AWARDS

- **Koopmans Scholarship, Tilburg University, Netherlands (2020)**: Awarded for academic excellence.
- **Lemann Foundation Scholarship, UCLA, USA (2017)**: Merit scholarship to students admitted to Harvard, Stanford, MIT, Columbia, UCLA or Oxford.
- **Global Pre-MBA Leadership Program, Yale University, USA (2013)**: Selected as one of 50 young leaders worldwide to explore MBA education; sponsored by Goldman Sachs.
- **The Club of Rome, Switzerland (2012)**: 60 young leaders selected for an international leadership initiative.
- **Mechanical Engineering, UFRJ (2012)**: Graduated *cum laude*, highest grade in the cohort.
- **Brazilian Government & US Department of Education (2011)**: Scholarship at North Carolina State University.
- **General Electric Scholar-Leader Program, Brazil (2010)**: Scholarship to top 10 Brazilian engineering students.

SKILLS

- **Data Science & Machine Learning**: Python (Functions, Pandas, Scikit-learn, statsmodel)
- **Experimentation & Causal Inference**: A/B test design (hypothesis testing), Difference-in-Differences (DiD)
- **Data Engineering**: SQL, Python, dbt, Snowflake, Redshift, Databricks, BigQuery, DuckDB, ETL/ELT pipelines
- **BI & Data Visualization**: Metabase, Looker, Rill, PowerBI, Tableau
- **Infrastructure & DevOps**: AWS (S3, IAM), Docker (basic), Git, GitHub Actions (CI/CD)
- **Applied AI**: LLM systems (prompt design fundamentals, context injection, basic RAG)
- **Languages**: Portuguese (Native), English (Fluent), Spanish (Fluent)

SELECTED PROJECTS & ACTIVITIES

- **Competitive Football**: Played competitive amateur football in organized leagues across four countries.
- **Professional Content & Community**: Built an audience of **6,000+ followers on LinkedIn**.
- **Mathematics & Statistics Foundations for Causal Machine Learning**: Developing a course on the mathematical foundations in probability and statistical inference, required for modern causal methods.